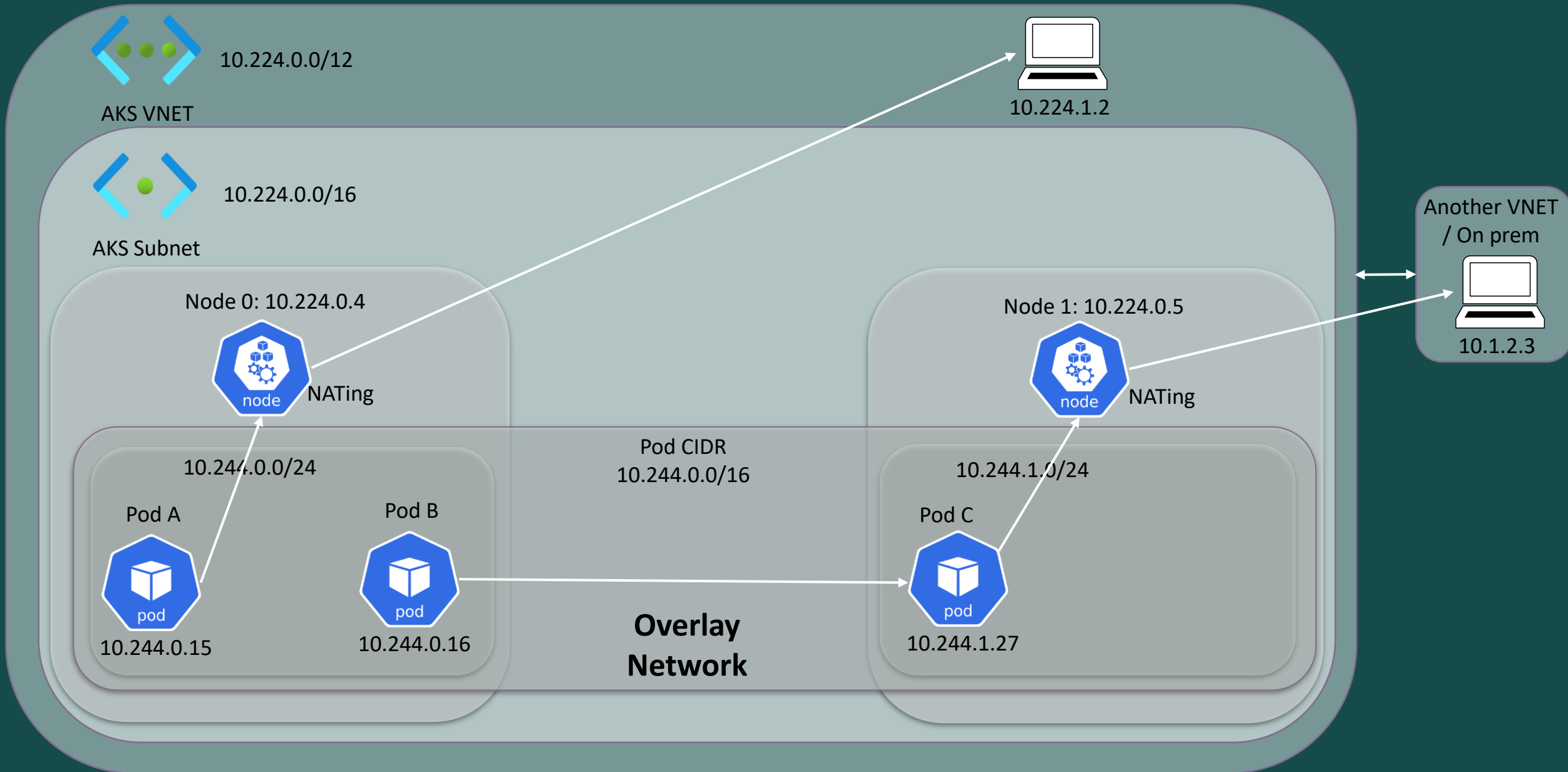


Azure CNI overlay network plugin

- IP address assignment:
 - Nodes: from AKS subnet
 - Pods: from pod CIDR
- An overlay network is utilized for pod and node traffic inside the cluster, and Network Address Translation (using the node's IP address) is applied to access resources outside the cluster
- The pod CIDR is broken into smaller pieces and assigned to nodes
- In the Azure Networking stack, a separate routing domain is built for the pod's CIDR space, resulting in the creation of an overlay network allowing direct communication between pods
- Pods need to be exposed via a Kubernetes Load Balancer to be accessed by endpoints outside the cluster
- `--network-plugin azure --network-plugin-mode overlay`

Azure CNI overlay network plugin



Azure CNI overlay network plugin

- **Why would you choose Azure CNI overlay?**
 - It doesn't require many IP addresses
 - It's a good option if the pods' communication is predominant within the cluster, having less hops than kubenet because the pod-to-pod communication in the Azure Networking stack
 - It supports up to 1000 nodes
- **What disadvantages apply to Azure CNI overlay?**
 - If a lot of communication is with resources outside the cluster, there is the extra hop and NAT at node level, so in this situation traditional CNI may be better
 - It doesn't support features like Virtual Nodes and Windows Server 2019, but it supports Windows Server 2022
 - You cannot have Application Gateway as an Ingress Controller (AGIC) for an overlay cluster